

Thursday, 11 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Rain

16° 11°

BIRMINGHAM

Rain

17° 11°

MANCHESTER

Light rain

15° 11°

GLASGOW

Rain

14° 10°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 **A senior terror adviser has described the recent knife attack disorder in Belfast as 'destabilising' for the region.**

Jonathan Hall KC told a broadcaster that discussing immigration in relation to national security was 'absolutely legitimate'. This follows widespread unrest and protests across Northern Ireland.

CRIME · UK

- 2 **The five children of Sara Sharif, who was found dead last year, will remain in Pakistan after Surrey County Council withdrew from their case.**

The council had been trying to bring the children back to the UK. Sara Sharif's father, stepmother, and uncle are wanted by police in connection with her death.

CRIME · UK

- 3 **Police have launched a manhunt after a prisoner escaped from a transport van on a busy street in Woolwich, south-east London.**

Twenty-five-year-old Temitope Segun absconded on Woolwich High Street. Members of the public are advised not to approach him but to call 999 immediately.

CRIME · UK

- 4 **A man who murdered his partner and then blew up their north London home has been jailed for his horrific crimes.**

Clifton George stabbed Annabel Rook 31 times before deliberately starting a fire at their house. The explosion caused extensive damage and put neighbours at risk.

CRIME · UK

- 5 **An Iranian group could soon be officially labelled a national threat under proposed new government legislation.**

The National Security (State Threats) Bill is expected to become law within weeks. This move aims to bolster the UK's defences against hostile state activity.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

1 **The first celebrity contestant for this year's Strictly Come Dancing has been officially confirmed: it's EastEnders star Lacey Turner!**

Lacey is best known for her iconic role as Stacey Slater in the popular BBC One soap, which she joined way back in 2004. Fans are already buzzing about her potential on the dancefloor.

ON AIR – Do you think Lacey Turner will be a good contestant on Strictly? Who else would you love to see join the line-up?

TV · AUTUMN 2026

2 **Rock and metal fans, get ready! Donington Park is gearing up to host the UK's biggest festival of rock and metal music, Download Festival.**

Thousands of music lovers will descend on the legendary site for a weekend of head-banging, mosh pits, and incredible live performances. It's a huge event in the rock calendar.

ON AIR – Are you heading to Download Festival this year, or is rock and metal not quite your thing? What's your favourite festival memory?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK

3 **In a rather unexpected twist, Chelsea footballers Cole Palmer and Joao Pedro have made a surprise appearance in a new Madonna video!**

The two forwards feature in a promotional film for the pop icon's upcoming album. It's an unusual crossover, bringing together the worlds of football and pop music.

ON AIR – What do you make of footballers popping up in music videos? Can you think of any other surprising celebrity cameos?

MUSIC · SOON

4 **British actor Idris Elba has shared his thoughts on the future of James Bond, saying the franchise shouldn't try to make the character 'woke'.**

He also suggested that some audiences might not accept a black male actor playing 007. Elba has long been a fan favourite to take on the role.

ON AIR – What do you think about Idris Elba's comments on James Bond? Should the character stick to tradition, or evolve with the times?

FILM · FUTURE

5 **The rumour mill is in overdrive as fans worldwide are speculating about the potential wedding date for pop superstar Taylor Swift and Travis Kelce.**

Swifties are meticulously searching for clues about the couple's upcoming nuptials. The pair have been a high-profile couple since last year.

ON AIR – Are you caught up in the Taylor Swift wedding speculation? Do you think celebrity couples should keep their big day private or share it with fans?

MUSIC · SOON

On the schedule

1 In a shock move, manager Kieran McKenna has resigned from Ipswich Town just as the club was preparing for its Premier League return.

Ipswich announced McKenna's departure, leaving fans stunned ahead of their highly anticipated top-flight campaign. He had guided them to back-to-back promotions.

ON AIR – What do you make of Kieran McKenna leaving Ipswich right before their Premier League season? Is it a good move for him, or a blow for the club?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 Serena Williams' doubles campaign at Queen's is now in doubt after her partner Victoria Mboko suffered a knee injury in her singles match.

Mboko retired from her match against Karolina Pliskova after a heavy fall. The pair were scheduled to play together in the doubles on Thursday.

ON AIR – How much of a blow is this for Serena Williams and her doubles hopes at Queen's? Do you think she'll still be able to compete?

TENNIS · UK

3 Tottenham Hotspur have completed the signing of Marcos Senesi on a free transfer, following his departure from Bournemouth.

Spurs confirmed the deal, adding the defender to their squad ahead of the new season. He'll be looking to make an impact in the Premier League.

ON AIR – What do you think of Tottenham's new signing? Is he a good addition for the club, and will he fit into their plans?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 Nat Sciver-Brunt found some valuable form as England's women's cricket team overcame India in their final warm-up match.

The win comes just before the Women's T20 World Cup is set to begin on Friday. Sciver-Brunt's performance will boost confidence within the squad.

ON AIR – How important is it for key players like Nat Sciver-Brunt to hit form just before a major tournament? Are you looking forward to the Women's T20 World Cup?

CRICKET · UK

5 Ireland's Aoife Wafer has retained her title as the Women's Six Nations Player of the Championship for the second year in a row.

The forward's outstanding performances have been recognised once again. It's a fantastic achievement for the talented Irish player.

ON AIR – What does it say about Aoife Wafer's talent to win this award two years running? Who are your favourite players in women's rugby?

RUGBY · UK

Quick hits

- 1 British gardeners are finding a new joy in 'micro-gardening', cultivating tiny plants in unusual containers.**
From old teacups to miniature terrariums, enthusiasts are creating charming, diminutive green spaces perfect for windowsills and small flats. It's a delightful way to bring a bit of nature indoors.
- 2 The trend of 'urban foraging' is growing, with more Brits learning to identify edible plants in local parks and green spaces.**
Courses are popping up across the country, teaching people how to safely find wild garlic, elderflowers, and berries, reconnecting them with nature and providing free, fresh ingredients.
- 3 More people are embracing 'mindful walking' as a way to de-stress and appreciate their surroundings.**
It's not just about getting from A to B; it's about paying close attention to sights, sounds, and smells, turning a simple stroll into a refreshing mental break.
- 4 The simple pleasure of 'community book swaps' is flourishing, with little outdoor libraries appearing in neighbourhoods.**
These charming, often decorated, cabinets allow people to take a book and leave a book, fostering a sense of shared enjoyment and discovery within local communities.
- 5 A new appreciation for 'vintage board games' is bringing families and friends together for retro fun.**
Dusting off classics like 'Cluedo' and 'Monopoly', people are enjoying screen-free evenings filled with laughter and a touch of nostalgic competition.
- 6 British bakers are rediscovering the joy of 'sourdough starter sharing' amongst friends and neighbours.**
Instead of buying new, keen bakers are sharing a portion of their active starter, creating a lovely connection and ensuring delicious, homemade bread for everyone.
- 7 The delightful art of 'nature journaling' is helping people connect more deeply with the outdoors.**
Combining sketching, writing, and observation, it's a calm and creative way to document findings from a walk in the park or a trip to the countryside, encouraging mindfulness.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 50% of us admit to secretly 'rescuing' what from the bottom of our crisp packet?

ANSWER: THE LITTLE FLAVOURFUL CRUMBS, OF COURSE!

Q A recent poll asked Brits what small, everyday sound instantly makes them feel cosy and content. What came out on top?

ANSWER: THE GENTLE PATTERN OF RAIN ON THE WINDOWPANE.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you hear a piece of music and it just makes you want to get up and dance, no matter where you are?

What's that one song that instantly puts a spring in your step and gets your toes tapping, even if you're just doing the washing up?

- We all have those moments when a piece of advice, perhaps from a family member or a wise friend, just really sticks with you.

What's the best piece of wisdom you've ever received that you still remember and perhaps even live by today?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that flamingos get their pink colour from the food they eat? Their diet of brine shrimp and algae contains pigments called carotenoids.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The chameleon's tongue is so fast that it can catch a fly mid-flight in less than a tenth of a second, making it one of the quickest movements in the animal kingdom.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£14 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£14 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of ferrets is called a business.
- The world's oldest known living tree, named Methuselah, is a Great Basin bristlecone pine located in the White Mountains of California and is over 4,850 years old.
- Bananas are technically berries, while strawberries are not.
- It is impossible for most people to lick their own elbow.
- The inventor of the Pringle's can is buried in one.
- The small plastic table often found in the middle of a pizza box is called a 'pizza saver' or 'package protector'.
- The word 'gymnasium' comes from the Greek word 'gymnasion', which literally means 'to train naked'.
- The Great Wall of China is not visible from space with the naked eye.

On this day

Day 162 of the year, 203 days left in 2026. Today Brazilian Navy Day (Brazil); Christian feast day: Alice of Schaerbeek; Christian feast day: Barnabas the Apostle; Christian feast day: Bartholomew the Apostle (Eastern Christianity). Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1984 — Andy Lee, Irish boxer
- 1978 — Joshua Jackson, Canadian-American actor
- 1964 — Penny Ford, American singer
- 1997 — Kodak Black, American rapper
- 1939 — Rachael Heyhoe Flint, Baroness Heyhoe Flint, English cricketer and journalist (died 2017)
- 1937 — Chad Everett, American actor and director (died 2012)
- 1997 — Jorja Smith, English singer
- 2001 — Billy Gilmour, Scottish footballer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1978 — Altaf Hussain founds the student political movement All Pakistan Muhajir Students Organisation (APMSO) in Karachi University.
- 2013 — Greece's public broadcaster ERT is shut down by then-prime minister Antonis Samaras. It would be opened exactly two years later by then-prime minister Alexis Tsipras.
- 1971 — The U.S. Government forcibly removes the last holdouts to the Native American Occupation of Alcatraz, ending 19 months of control.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1962 — Frank Morris, John Anglin and Clarence Anglin allegedly become the only prisoners to escape from the prison on Alcatraz Island.
- 2007 — Mudslides in Chittagong, Bangladesh, kill 130 people.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1963 — American Civil Rights Movement: Governor of Alabama George Wallace defiantly stands at the door of Foster Auditorium at the University of Alabama in an attempt to block two black students, Vivian Malone and James Hood, from attending that school. Later in the day, accompanied...

- 1971 — The U.S. Government forcibly removes the last holdouts to the Native American Occupation of Alcatraz, ending 19 months of control.
- 1944 — USS Missouri, the last battleship built by the United States Navy and future site of the signing of the Japanese Instrument of Surrender, is commissioned.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 163 of the year, 202 days left in 2026. Today Chaco Armistice Day (Paraguay); Christian feast day: 108 Martyrs of World War II; Christian feast day: Basilides; Christian feast day: Blessed Hildegard Burjan. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1978 — Lewis Moody, English rugby player
- 1990 — David Worrall, English footballer
- 1951 — Brad Delp, American musician and singer (died 2007)
- 1992 — Allie DiMeco, American actress and musician
- 1949 — John Wetton, English singer-songwriter, bass player, and producer (died 2017)
- 1952 — Junior Brown, American country music singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1956 — Michael Angelo Batio, American heavy metal guitarist
- 1934 — Kevin Billington, English director and producer (died 2021)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1988 — Austral Líneas Aéreas Flight 046, a McDonnell Douglas MD-81, crashes short of the runway at Libertador General José de San Martín Airport, killing all 22 people on board.
- 1999 — Kosovo War: Operation Joint Guardian begins when a NATO-led United Nations peacekeeping force, Kosovo Force (KFor), enters the province of Kosovo in the Federal Republic of Yugoslavia.
- 1954 — Pope Pius XII canonises Dominic Savio, who was 14 years old at the time of his death, as a saint, making him at the time the youngest unmartyred saint in the Roman Catholic Church. In 2017, Francisco and Jacinta Marto, aged ten and nine at the time of their deaths, are declare...

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1987 — The Central African Republic's former emperor Jean-Bédel Bokassa is sentenced to death for crimes he had committed during his 13-year rule.
- 1988 — Austral Líneas Aéreas Flight 046, a McDonnell Douglas MD-81, crashes short of the runway at Libertador General José de San Martín Airport, killing all 22 people on board.

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026	
FRI 12	Scary Movie 6; new Spielberg film (+ IMAX)
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
11–14 JUN	World Cup of Darts	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)